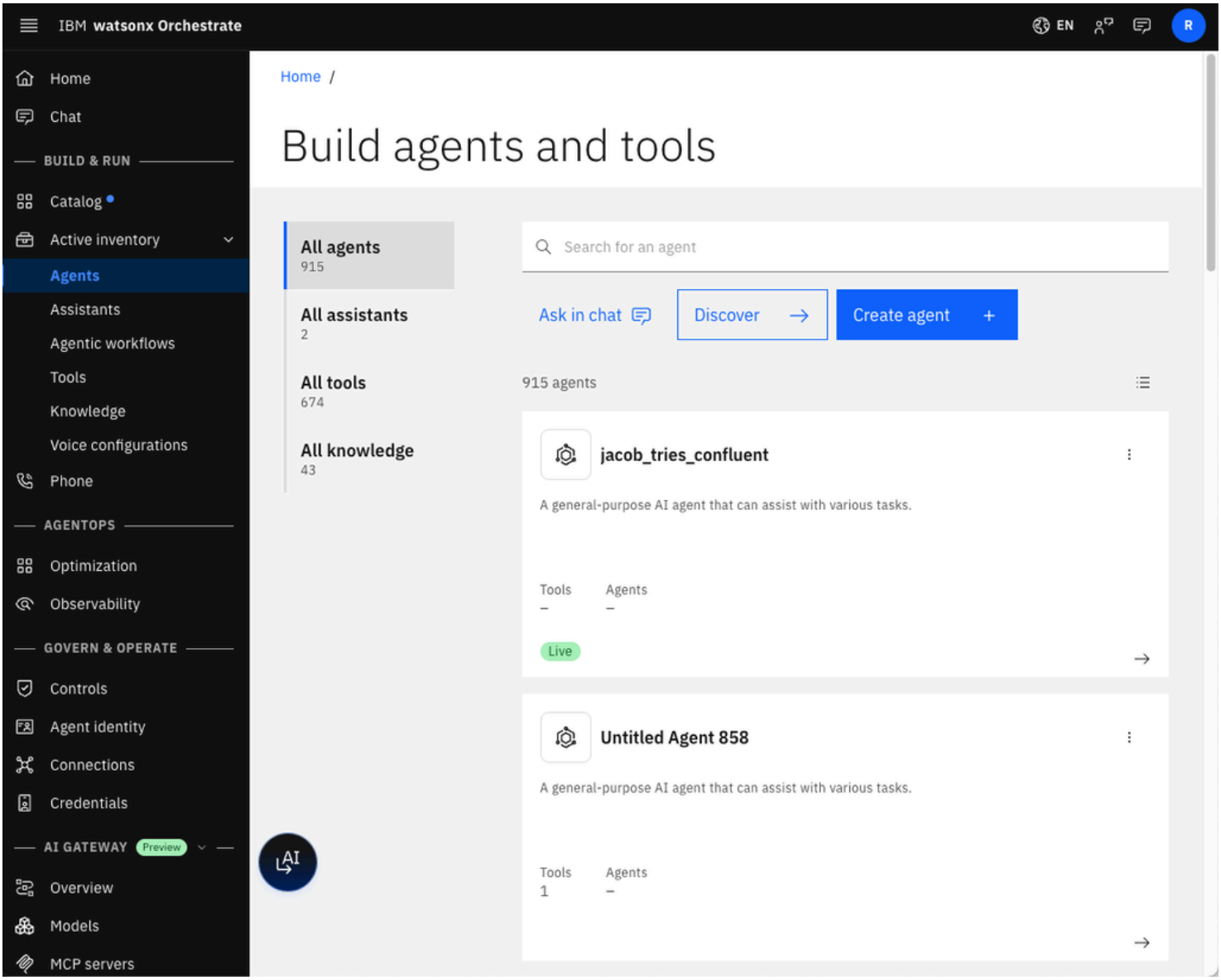
Confluent + wxo user guide

Overview

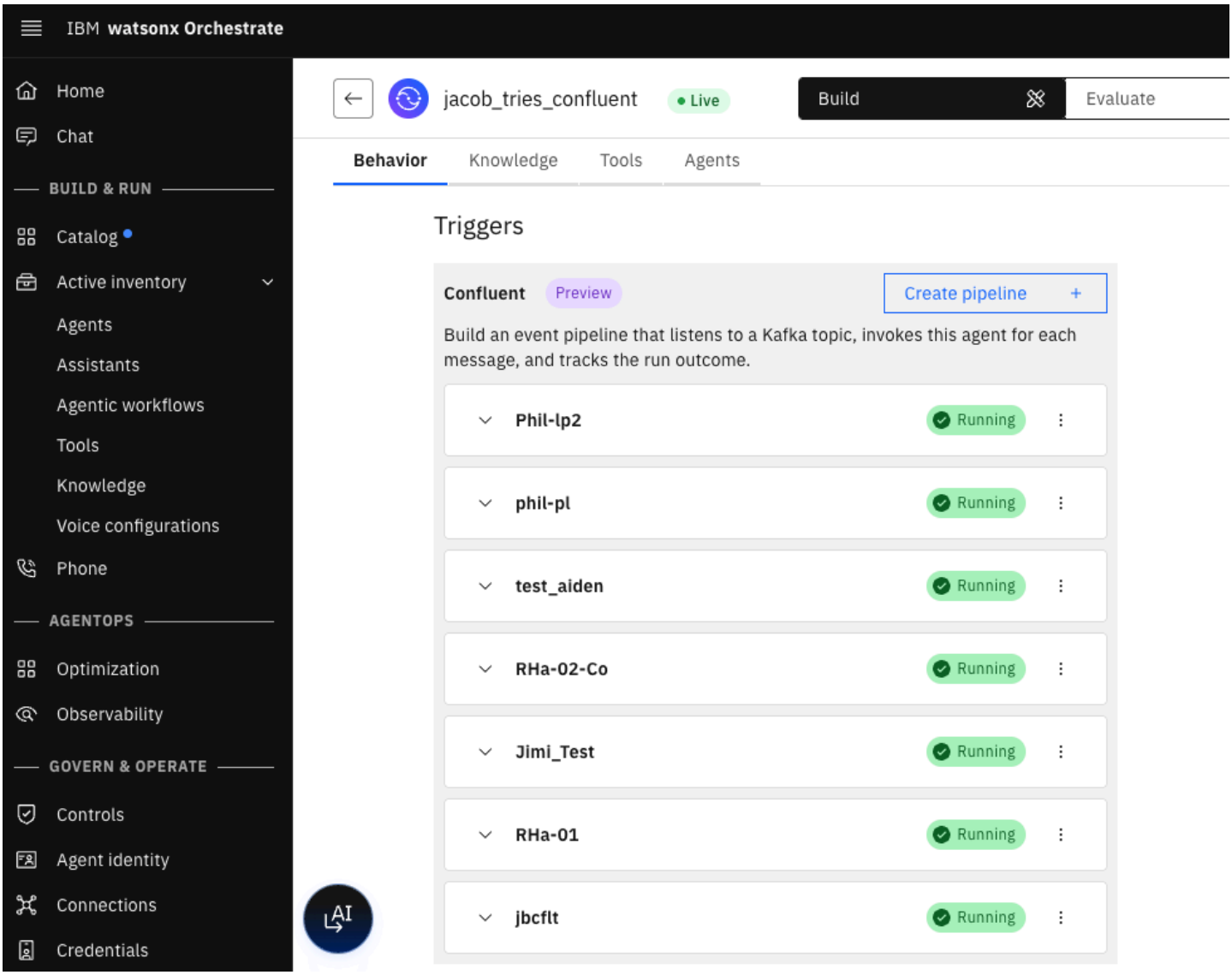
Confluent enables **event-driven agents** by integrating IBM watsonx Orchestrate with Confluent event streams. Instead of waiting for a user to initiate a chat, agents can automatically respond and take action when an event occurs in a business system.
You will be able to build an event pipeline that listens to a Kafka topic, invokes an agent for each relevant message, and tracks the outcome of each agent run.

How to start

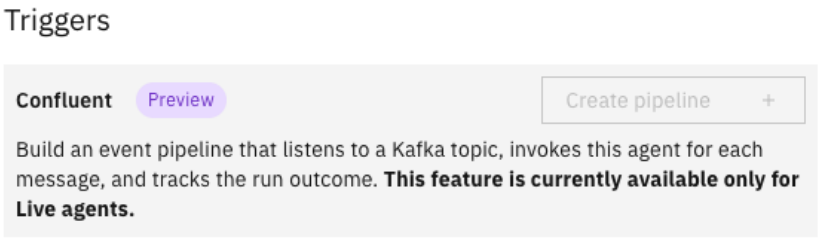
1. In watsonx orchestrate create or choose already build agent.



2. You'll be taken to the **agent setup page**, where you can configure the agent's behavior, knowledge sources, tools, and connections to other agents.
   Start with the **Behavior** tab and scroll down to the **Triggers** section.

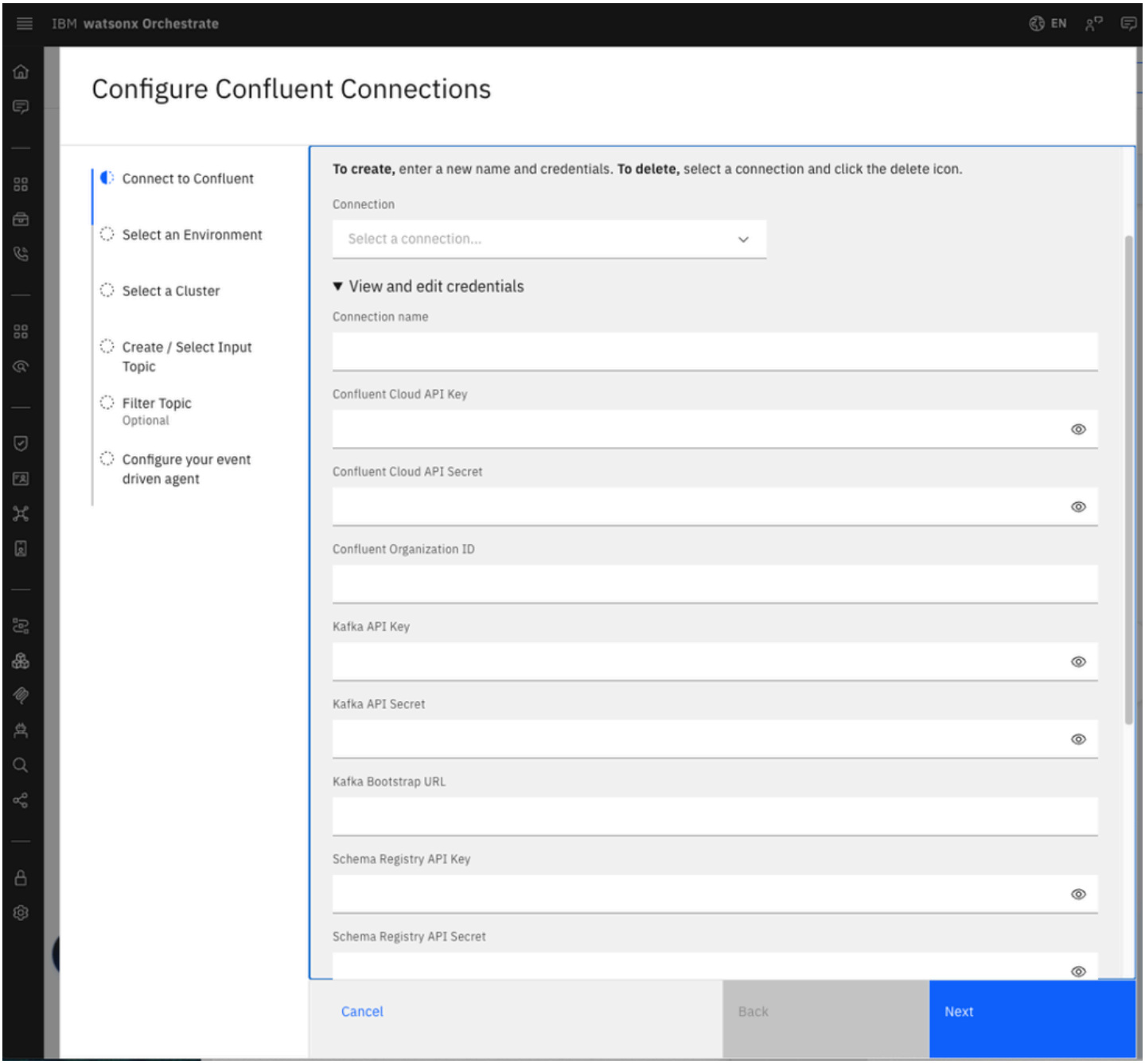


Remember: Before creating an event pipeline, make sure your **agent is deployed and live** (what will be indicated by green icon). Otherwise, the option to create a pipeline will be grayed out.



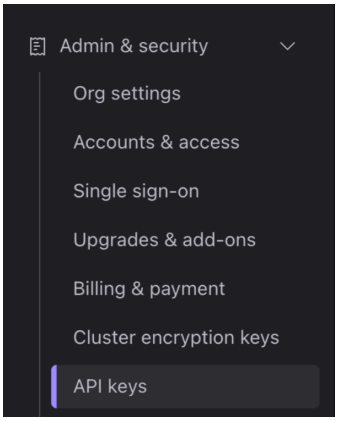
3. **Pipeline creation**
   Click on the “Create pipeline” button and this will take you through the steps needed to properly setup Confluent connection,.

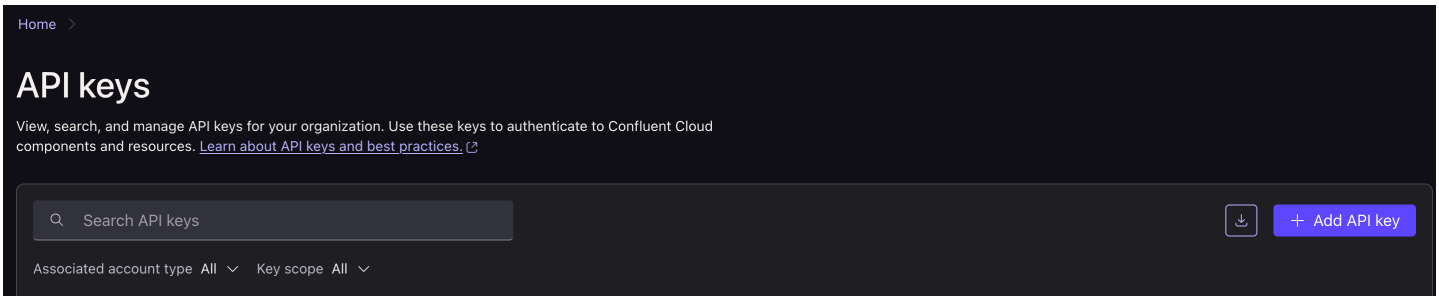
   On the first screen fil in necessary credential, like API keys, secredts and organization ID.



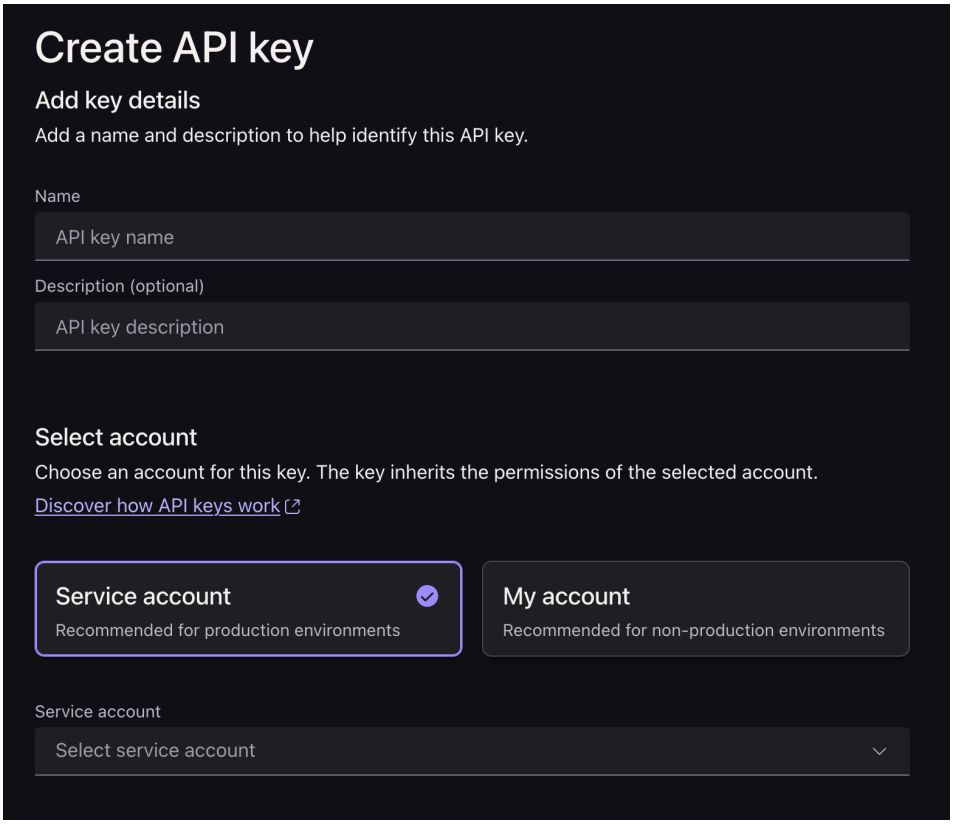
How to find Confluent credentials?

In the main menu go to Admin & Security > API Keys

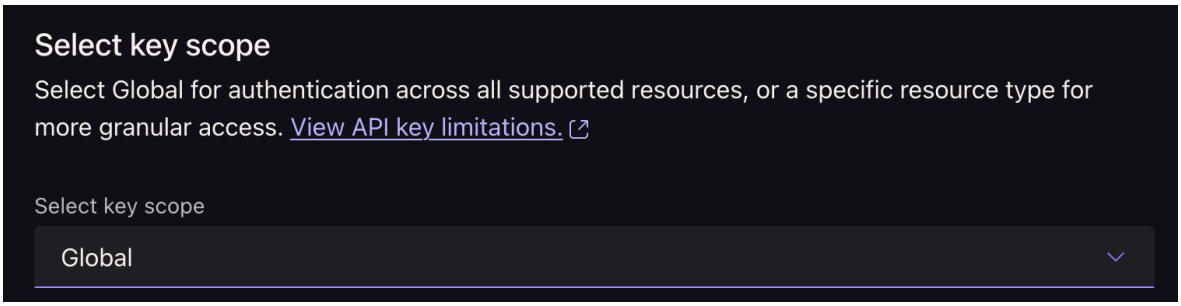




Select propper Account

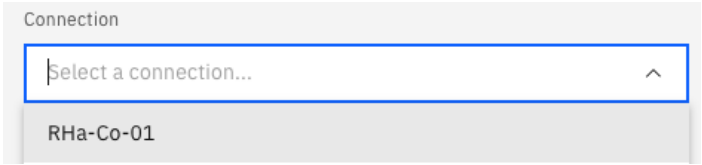


And lastly select Global key scope in the drop-down menu:



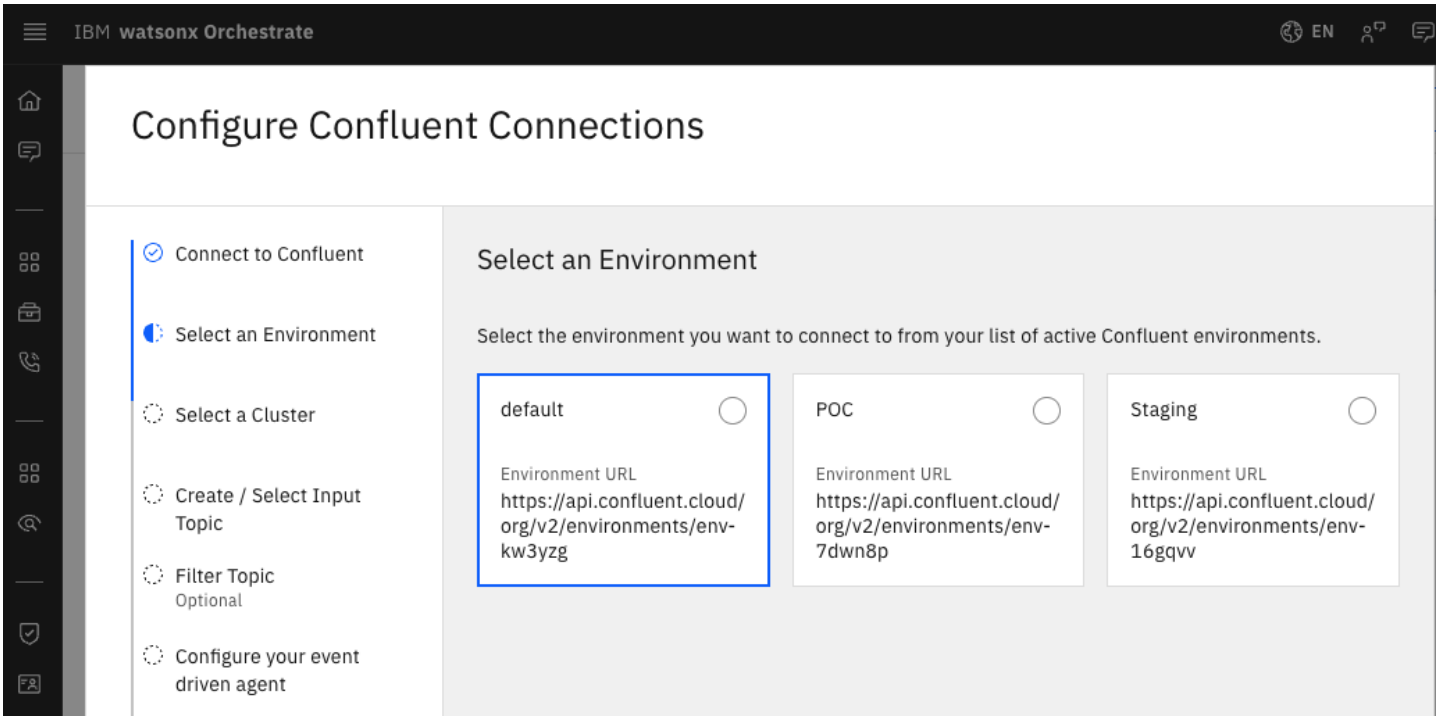
Remember: If you don't plan to use **custom SQL queries for event filtering**, you don't need to provide **Flink credentials**. Flink-related credentials are optional and are required only if you want to use a Filtered Topic.

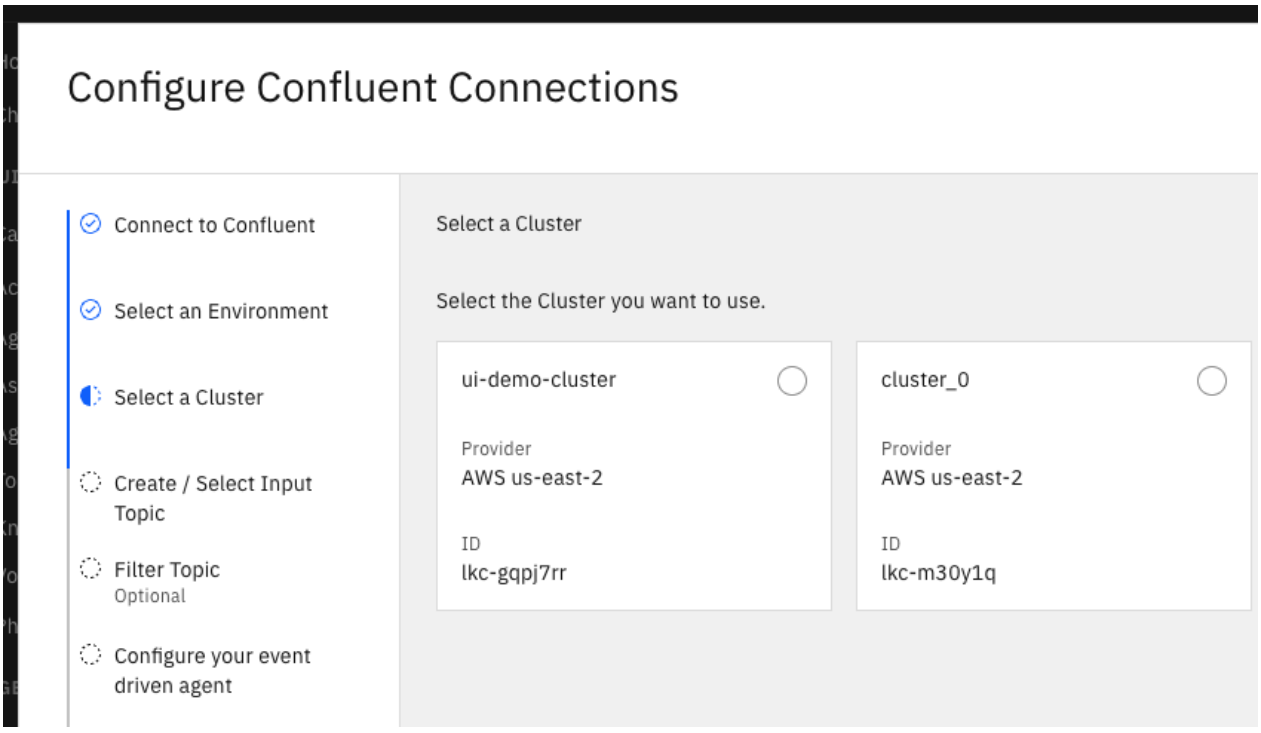
If an existing connection is available, you can select it from the drop-down menu under Connection.



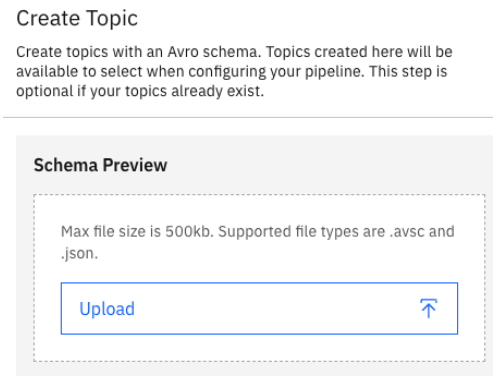
Remember: Deleting a connection will delete one that someone else created. We don't store who created a connection just it's details.

4. Next step is to select Confluent environment and Kafka cluster that you want to connect to.



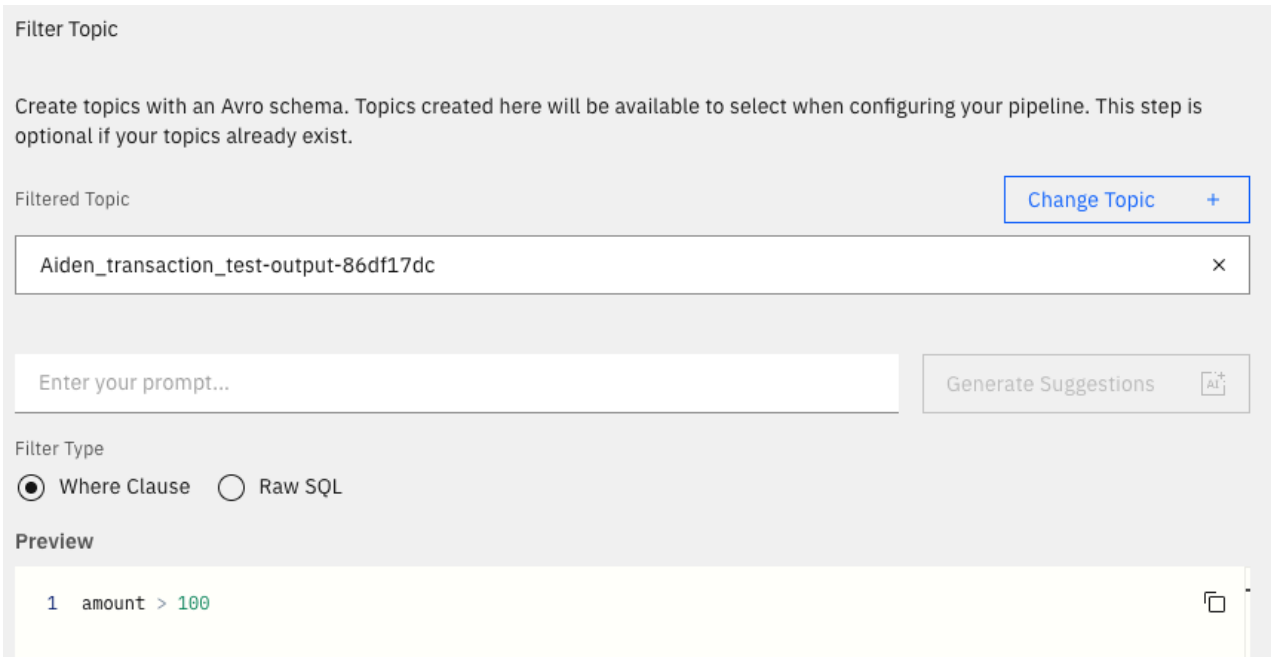


5. **Topic creation and selection.**
   Confluent topics allow users to filter relevant event streams and trigger agents based on selected topics. You can select an **existing topic** or create a new one by uploading an **Avro schema**. Any topic created here will be available when configuring your pipeline.

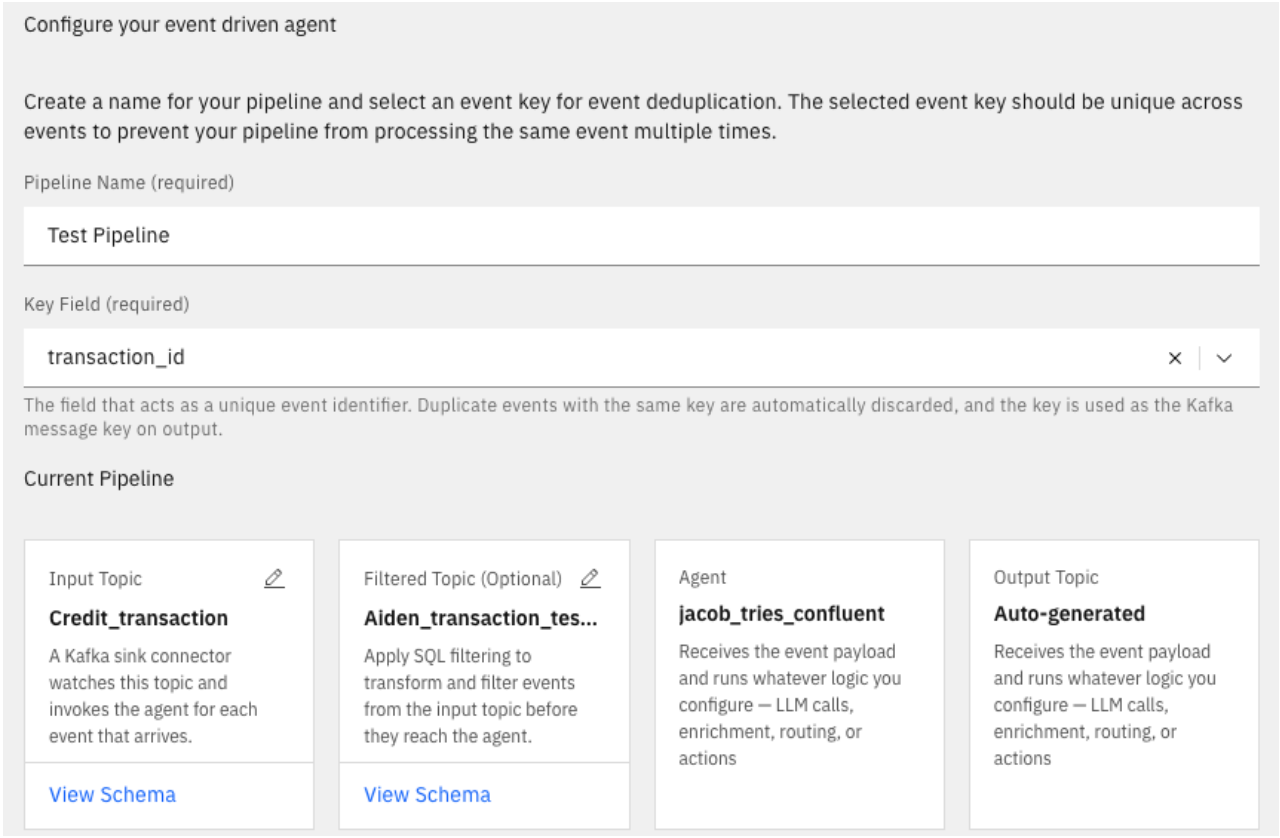


(Remember: to delete a topic, open the **three-dot menu** next to the topic and select the delete option.)

6. **Additional Filtering options with SQL editing**
   After creating or selecting a topic, click **Next**. From the topics list, open the **context menu** and select **Edit**. This allows you to add **custom SQL queries** to further refine the topic selection.

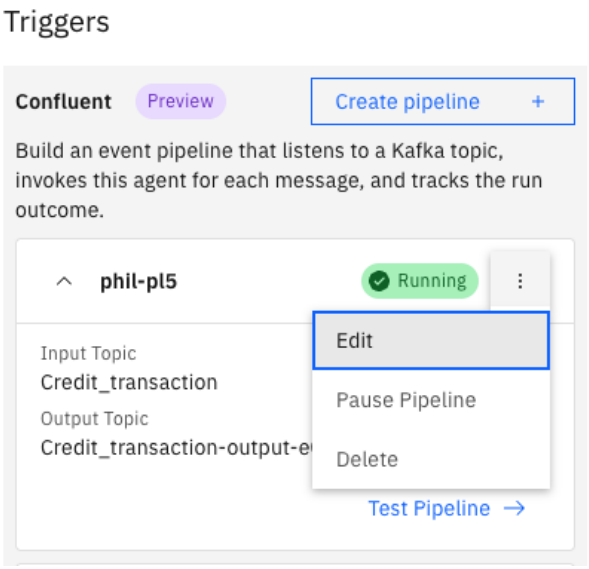


7. Last step is to create Pipeline Name, and select Key Field that will act as unique event identifier.



Pipeline Details View

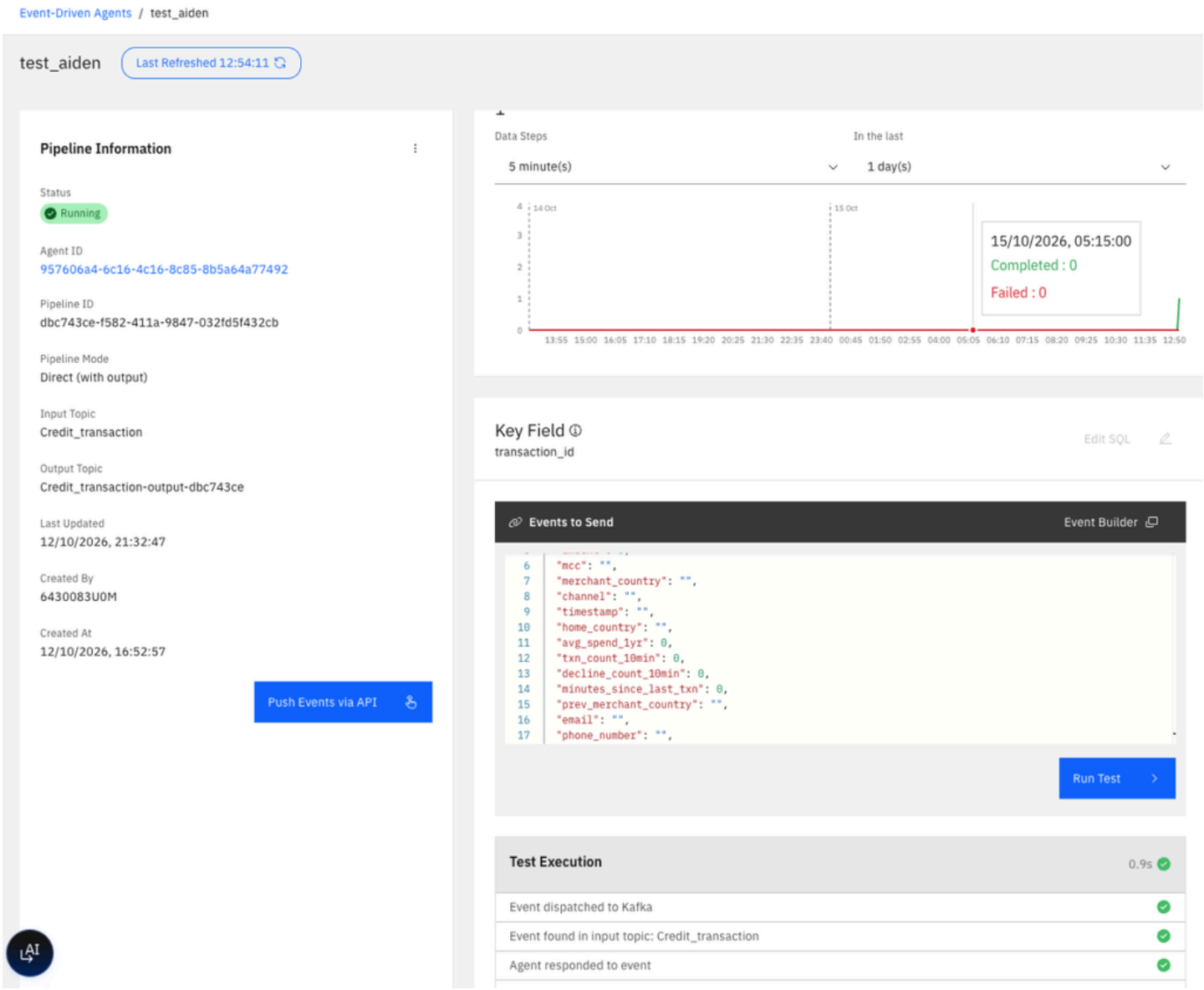
After completing the pipeline creation steps, you'll see a **detailed pipeline view**. You can also access this view by selecting a specific pipeline and clicking **Test Pipeline** or **Edit**.



Pipeline view is where you can check:

- General status
- Flink Statement Name
- Topics summary
- Event streams
- Edit SQL

- Run a test

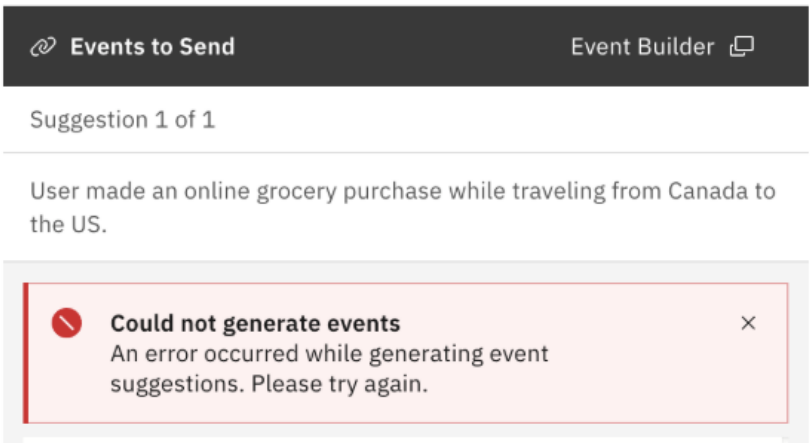


Troubleshooting and FAQ

- The **Edit SQL** button is disabled (greyed out) when no filters are configured and the pipeline uses **Direct** mode. To Edit SQL you have to set up Filtered Topics.
- If the agent fails, the pipeline will be **automatically paused to prevent further events from triggering the agent**.
- If you use **pre-existing topics** for an event-driven agent and those topics are already receiving events, the **test execution will show the number of events received**.
- For more information related to Confluent use Officail Confluen Documentation page: Confluent Documentation

Known Issues

- Event Builder suggestions intermittently fails with `Could not generate events`
  This is a **rare issue** that can occasionally occur during LLM calls. We're working to resolve it.



- When creating a pipeline, clicking the **Create Pipeline** button can sometimes return a 403 error with: `policy violation error` or `Connection ID xxx uses bootstrap servers that are blocked by the tenant's outgoing policy.`
  To fix this, users need to go to **wxO → Control → Enterprise Control → Network → Outbound Control** and add the Kafka bootstrap server there, then try creating the pipeline again.

